

Cirque Corporation

Employee Performance Management Policy

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1. Introduction

Effective performance management ensures employees understand expectations, receive feedback, and have opportunities for growth and development at Cirque Corporation.

2. Purpose

This policy establishes a fair and consistent process for evaluating employee performance, providing feedback, recognizing achievements, and addressing performance issues.

3. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Cirque Corporation. Contractors and temporary staff may have similar assessments as defined in their agreements.

4. Performance Evaluation Cycle

Performance evaluations shall be conducted:

- Annually for all employees
- At 90 days for new hires (probationary review)
- More frequently for employees with performance concerns
- Following significant role changes or promotions

5. Performance Standards

Performance shall be evaluated based on:

- Achievement of job-specific goals and objectives
- Quality and timeliness of work
- Technical competency and skills
- Communication and collaboration
- Adherence to company policies and values
- Security awareness and compliance (for IT roles)
- Professional development and growth

6. Goal Setting

Managers and employees shall:

- Establish SMART goals (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound)
- Align individual goals with department and company objectives
- Document goals in writing
- Review and adjust goals quarterly as needed

7. Performance Review Process

The review process includes:

- Employee self-assessment
- Manager evaluation and rating
- One-on-one review meeting
- Discussion of accomplishments and areas for improvement
- Setting goals for next evaluation period
- Development plan for skill enhancement
- Documentation in employee file

8. Performance Ratings

Employees shall be rated on a scale:

- Exceeds Expectations: Consistently performs above requirements
- Meets Expectations: Consistently performs at required level
- Needs Improvement: Performance below expectations in some areas
- Unsatisfactory: Performance significantly below requirements

Ratings consider the full evaluation period, not just recent performance.

9. Continuous Feedback

Managers shall provide:

- Regular informal feedback (ongoing)
- Recognition of achievements promptly
- Constructive feedback on areas for improvement
- Mid-year check-ins (formal or informal)
- Real-time feedback on critical issues

10. Performance Improvement Plans

For employees rated "Needs Improvement" or "Unsatisfactory":

- Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) developed
- Specific performance deficiencies identified
- Clear expectations and measurable goals set
- Timeline for improvement (typically 30-90 days)
- Regular progress reviews conducted
- HR involved in process
- Consequences of continued poor performance explained

11. Recognition and Rewards

High performers shall be recognized through:

- Formal recognition programs
- Performance-based bonuses or raises
- Promotion opportunities
- Professional development opportunities
- Additional responsibilities and growth opportunities

12. Documentation

All performance management activities shall be documented:

- Performance evaluations in employee file
- Goal setting worksheets

- Performance improvement plans
- Feedback and coaching sessions
- Recognition and disciplinary actions

13. Training for Managers

All managers shall receive training on:

- Conducting effective performance reviews
- Providing constructive feedback
- Setting SMART goals
- Managing difficult conversations
- Legal compliance in performance management